

Safe Automatic Litter Box Guide — Action Checklist

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VERIFY ROTATION DESIGN BEFORE BUYING

- ☐ **Verify Rotation Design Before Buying:** Confirm the device uses X-axis rotation instead of Y-axis rotation before purchasing any automatic litter box, because Y-axis drums create a crushing hazard if sensors fail.
- ☐ **Verify Rotation Design Before Buying:** Reject any model with a fixed plastic entry door or tunnel, since these create dangerous pinch points that can trap your cat's collar, tail, or limbs during operation.
- ☐ **Verify Rotation Design Before Buying:** Research sensor failure rates for the specific model you're considering, using APPA 2025 data showing 35% of users experience sensor malfunctions within the first year as a baseline comparison.
- ☐ **Verify Rotation Design Before Buying:** Search for lawsuits, recalls, and documented incident reports connected to the manufacturer before buying, especially after reviewing cases like the June 2025 PetPivot lawsuit that resulted in a \$3 million claim.

TEST SAFETY FEATURES BEFORE USE

- ☐ **Test Safety Features Before Use:** Test weight sensor detection specifically for your cat's body weight, since small cats under 10 pounds and senior cats are at highest risk for sensor detection failures.
- ☐ **Test Safety Features Before Use:** Verify the device has redundant safety sensors rather than relying on a single detection system, which provides a backup if the primary sensor fails during a cleaning cycle.
- ☐ **Test Safety Features Before Use:** Run a manual test cycle with your cat nearby to observe how the mechanism responds when motion is detected, confirming it fully pauses and does not continue rotating.
- ☐ **Test Safety Features Before Use:** Observe for false positives during the first weeks of use, such as the device locking up or refusing to cycle when no cat is present, which indicate sensor instability.

MONITOR DEVICE AFTER SETUP

- ☐ **Monitor Device After Setup:** Log any sensor inconsistencies you notice from day one, since intermittent sensor failures can develop gradually before causing a dangerous malfunction.
 - ☐ **Monitor Device After Setup:** Never leave your cat alone with the automatic litter box during the initial trial period until you have confirmed reliable sensor performance over multiple weeks.
 - ☐ **Monitor Device After Setup:** Verify the mechanism maintains a clear exit path at all times during operation and never fully encloses your cat inside a rotating chamber that has no escape route.
 - ☐ **Monitor Device After Setup:** Report any entrapment incident, injury, or near-miss to the manufacturer and appropriate consumer safety authorities immediately, regardless of how minor the incident may seem.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.